

וְאָכַלְתָּ וְשָׂבַעְתָּ וּבֵרַכְתָּ אֶת הוֹי' אֱלֹהֶיךָ

Ve'Ochaltoh VeSovotoh Uveirachtoh Es Havaye Elokechoh

Maamor — free translation & elucidation · Shabbos Parshas Eikev, 16 Menachem Av 5743 · bilti-mugah

MAAMOR

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There is a Possuk in this week's Parsha that reads: ,

וְאָכַלְתָּ וְשָׂבַעְתָּ וּבֵרַכְתָּ אֶת הוֹי' אֱלֹהֶיךָ עַל הָאָרֶץ הַטֹּבָה אֲשֶׁר נָתַן לָךְ



And you will eat and be satisfied, and you shall bless Hashem, your G-d, for the good land He has given you". Our Sages of blessed memory have asked;

the instruction to Bentch with a Zimmun in which Hashem's name is invoked. The words 'For the land', is the instruction for the blessing of the land; the word 'good', is the blessing: 'Who builds Yerusholayim' and it also says: "This good mountain and Lebanon" (Devorim 3:25), which is interpreted homiletically as referring to Yerusholayim and the Beis Hamikdosh. The words in the Possuk 'That He has given you', is the blessing of ' –

Who is good and does good'.

However, there is only a Torah source for the blessings after eating, i.e., Grace after Meals. From where is it derived that one is obligated to recite blessings before eating? It can be derived through an a fortiori inference: If when one is satisfied, he is obligated to recite a blessing and thank Hashem for food; when he is hungry, all the more so that he should recite a

in the Torah do we derive the obligation to recite 'Birkas Hamazon'? blessing to offer thanks for the food he will eat. and finishes with the words :

ברוךְ עַל־הָאֶרֶץ וְעַל־הַמָּזוֹן

.אֵל תֵּה'.

From the words of our Possuk; לֹא־תִשָּׁבַע עַל־יְבֹרָכְךָ וְעַל־יְשׁוּבְךָ אֵלֶּךָ we derive the blessing of הַ-
'Who feeds all'.

those who were massacred in Beitar were finally allowed to be interred. {This is also the connection to the fifteenth day of the Hebrew month of 'Ov'. For there are several reasons for created a uniform prayer service for the Jewish people. Although the Amidah already existed it was not written down and there were many versions. They added the Brocho of VelaMalshinim to the Amidah and Hatov VeHaMeitiv as an additional Brocha to recite alongside the three Biblical blessings to be recited after partaking of bread to the volume of at least one olive. In Beitar: The last stronghold in the heroic Bar Kochba rebellion, fell to the Romans on the 9th of Av of the year 3893 (133 CE) after a three-year siege. The Romans were looking for the "final solution". They did not take Jewish prisoners to sell them as slaves, as they did in the war of the year 68. By orders of the emperor, they carried out a systematic and calculated genocide in all the territory of Judea, killing women, men and children. According to the texts of the Roman historians themselves, like Dio Cassius , fifty fortified cities and almost one thousand villages were completely razed, and a total of Five Hundred and Eighty thousand Jews were killed including Bar Kochba, the leader of the rebellion. Along with the most important Sage of the time: Rabbi El'azar of the city of Modiin. Beitar was a city of Torah and with many people. Beitar was considered unconquerable. Ninety percent of the inhabitants of Judea were massacred by the Romans who massacred the survivors of the battle with great cruelty and would not allow the Jews to bury their dead. The Romans piled hundreds of thousands of corpses in a large vineyard, watering the fields with the blood of the dead, and left them there, as a cynical tribute to their victory. Allowed to be interred: For fifteen years their remains were left around the vineyard. When the dead of Beitar were finally brought to burial on the fifteenth day of the Jewish month of Ov of the year 3908 from

creation (148 CE), an additional blessing (HaTov VehaMeitiv) was added to the "Grace After Meals" in commemoration.

celebration on the fifteenth day of 'Ov'. [The Talmud enumerates six reasons (or five, depending whether the consent for the different tribes to intermarry $\aleph$ and the Fifteenth day of Ov: In a Mishneh (Taanis 4:8) R. Shimon b. Gamliel said: There were never such joyous festivals for the B'nei Yisroel as the fifteenth of Ov (and Yom Kippur) for on this day: The maidens of Yerushalayim used to go out dressed in white garments danced in the vineyards, saying: "Young men, look and observe well whom you are about to choose as a spouse" ... In the Talmud (Taanis 30B) Rav Yehuda said that Shmuel said: "This was the day on which the members of different tribes were permitted to enter one another's tribe, by intermarriage. Rav Yosef said that Rav Nachman said: This was the day on which the tribe of Binyomin was permitted to enter the congregation of the Jewish people. After the other tribes ostracized them. (31A) Rav Masna said: it was the day that the slain of Beitar were brought to burial, several years (15 years) after the battle at Beitar (see Gittin 57a). And Rav Masna said: On the same day that the slain of Beitar were brought to burial, they instituted the blessing: Who is good and does good, at Yavneh. Who is good, thanking Hashem that the corpses did not decompose while awaiting burial, and does good, thanking Hashem that they were ultimately brought to burial. And elsewhere it says on this day the dying in the desert ceased in the fortieth year. Also on this day the checkpoints that Yerovom ben Nevot had set up to prevent the B'nei Yisroel from making the festival pilgrimage were abolished. And finally, on this day they stopped cutting wood for the wood pile, for from that day the power of the sun weakens so that it cannot rid the wood of its wetness. $\aleph$ Different tribes to intermarry: (Taanis 30B) For the first generation of the B'nei Yisroel who entered the land of Eretz Yisroel the men of each tribe were only allowed to marry the women of that particular tribe so as to keep each plot of land within the portion of the tribe that originally inherited it. This was instituted by the Torah in the wake of a complaint by the relatives of the daughters of Tzelofchod, who were worried that if these women married men from

consent to marry into the tribe of Binyomin $\beth$ is considered as two separate reasons $\aleph$ or one and the same reason). In the Kabbala there are seven reasons $\daleth$ brought which correspond to the Seven Middos] $\aleph$ One of the reasons is because on this day consent was given for the remains of those who were executed in Beitar to other tribes, the inheritance would be lost from that tribe (Bamidbor 36:1–12). $\beth$ To marry into the tribe of Binyomin: On this date the tribe of Binyomin, which had been excommunicated for its behaviour in the incident of the "Concubine at Giv'ah," was readmitted into the community of Yisroel (as related in Shoftim 19:25-29). $\aleph$ Two separate reasons: Although there are two completely different reasons for different incidents, one is to do with land and the other to do with an ostracization, ultimately it is the same result, that the cause of division was argued away and there was unity amongst the Jewish people in a greater way than it was before the annulment of the decree. $\daleth$ Seven reasons: To be joyous on the fifteenth of Ov commemorating seven joyous occurrences on that day of the year: 1. The dancing maidens of Jerusalem. 2. The dying of the generation of the Exodus ceased. 3. The tribes of Israel were permitted to intermarry. 4. The tribe of

Binyomin was permitted to reenter the community. 5. Hoshea ben Elah opened the roads to Jerusalem. 6. The dead of Beitar were allowed to be buried. 7. “The day of the breaking of the ax.” When the Beis Hamikdosh stood in Yerusholayim, the annual cutting of firewood for the Mizbeiach was concluded on the 15th of Av. The event was celebrated with feasting and rejoicing (as is the custom upon the conclusion of a holy endeavour), and included a ceremonial breaking of the axes, which gave the day its name.”¹⁰ Seven Middos: Seven emotive attributes and they are: Chessed (kindness), Gevurah (strength), Tiferes (beauty), Netzach (victory), Hod (splendour), Yesod (foundation) and Malchus (kingship).

be interred}. We need to understand the following question; What is it ¹¹that makes the first three blessings על־הַאֶרֶץ (and)

בְּיַהֲרֹשָׁלַיִם

Biblical “יט” whilst

הַמִּיִּטְבֵּן the fourth blessing remains Rabbinic? Our Sages of blessed memory also said (כא This is brought ¹²What is it: According to the inner dimension of Torah. ¹³Three blessings: Of Birkas Hamozon. ¹⁴Biblical: As an obligation to recite the first three blessings from the Torah.

הטוב והמטיב יט

: Who is good and does good.

This is a double Brocha when thanking Hashem for doing something good for the person reciting the blessing as well as benefitting others. In this case it was thanking Hashem for us that the bodies did not smell and thanking Hashem on behalf of the deceased that they finally got a kosher burial. Rabbinic: What is the significance of this blessing being Rabbinic? כא Sages also said: Talmud Brochos (20B) The ministering angels said before Hakodosh Boruch Hu: Master of the Universe, in Your Torah it is written: “The great, mighty and awesome Gd who favours no one and takes no bribe” Devorim (10:17), yet You, nevertheless, show favour to the B’nei Yisroel, as it is written: “Hashem shall show favour to you and give you peace” Bamidbor (6:26). He replied to them: And how can I not show favour to Yisroel, as I wrote for them in the Torah: “And you shall eat and be satisfied, and bless Hashem your G-d” Devorim (8:10), meaning that there is no obligation to bless Hashem until one is satisfied; yet they are exacting with themselves to recite Grace after Meals even if they have only eaten as much as the volume of an olive. Since they go beyond the requirements of the law, they are worthy of favour.

elsewhere in Chassidus) כב that the administering angels said to Hakodosh Boruch Hu:
“Master of the universe You have written in Your Torah that You will not show favouritism
כב yet You favour the B’nei Yisroel”. כד As the Possuk כה states: “

יֵשׁוּא ה' פָּנֵינוּ אֵלֵינוּ



כב Elsewhere in Chassidus: Ohr Hatorah Eikev p531 כב Favouritism: The Possuk states: .

כִּי ה' אֱלֹהֵינוּ הוּא אֱלֹהֵי הַשָּׁמַיִם אֱלֹהֵי הָאָרֶץ אֱלֹהֵי הַיָּם אֱלֹהֵי הַבְּרִיָּה הַגָּדוֹל הַגִּבּוֹר הַנּוֹרָא וְהַיָּדָא לֹא יִשְׁאַף פְּנֵים וְלֹא יִקַּח שֹׁחַד

For Hashem, your G-d, is G-d of gods and the Lord of the lords, the great mighty and awesome G-d, who will

show no favour, nor will He take a bribe” כד B’nei Yisroel: Over the other nations of the world. כה Possuk: In the priestly blessings (Bamidbor 6:26): .

יֵשׁוּא ה' פָּנֵינוּ אֵלֵינוּ לֵךְ יְיָ שֵׁם לְךָ שְׁלוֹם

May Hashem raise His countenance toward you and grant you peace.”

כז Responds: To the angels.

only eat as little as the volume of an olive.” כז In other Chassidic discourses the question is asked; in which way does the Jew’s meticulousness to recite Birkas Hamazon after the mere consumption of the volume of an olive warrant favouritism from heaven? כח Furthermore, we also need to understand, since they are already scrutinising the volume of their כט An olive: According to the Torah, since our Possuk says “And you shall eat and be satisfied”, we imply that a person is obligated to bless Hashem, when, and only when one is full from eating. However, the Jewish people take upon themselves the stringency to ensure that they ‘Bentch’ after meals even when they have only consumed a minute amount of food, as small as the volume of a ‘Kezayis’ - an olive which is far less than the amount one would normally need to satisfy one’s hunger. There are Halachic debates as to how much volume is the size of an average olive. Some say that it is half the size of an egg and others say it is equivalent to one third the size of an egg. There is also a debate if it is measured in volume or in weight. We must always be stringent with regards to anything Biblical. It is obviously a lot less than the volume one would need to eat to achieve satisfaction. כפ From heaven: Hence, what is the deeper,

unique symbolism behind being watchful and meticulous with saying Birkas Hamozon, that specifically due to our carefulness, we merit that G-d “raises” his face towards us? Because of which the B’nei Yisroel merit Hashem’s favouritism. Seemingly there must be a connection between the two! טכ Their consumption: If it is important to thank Hashem even when eating less than the Torah’s prescribed trigger, why stop at a Kezayis, why not say as soon as some has the minutest morsel of bread he already needs to ‘Bentch’?

consumption, why limit it to the size of an olive? Why not obligate themselves to Bentch even when they consume less than the volume of an olive? The answer can be understood by exploring the truth of the matter. Regarding the first three blessings הַרְצֵנוּ הָאֱלֹהִים (and)

בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל יִי

the Tzemach Tzedek explains that they correspond to the three states of ‘Chessed’

(Kindness) ‘Gevurah’ (Severity) and ‘Tiferes’ (Beauty). In other words, additional blessings shall be volume of an olive: i.e by eating anything, even a crumb!? Blessings: Of ‘Birkas Hamozon’. Tzemach Tzedek: Rabbi Menachem Mendel Schneerson, the Tzemach Tzedek of Lubavitch 1789 - 1866. Third Rebbe of Lubavich and the son-in-law of the Mittler Rebbe. Produced authoritative responsa on many areas of Jewish law called Tzemach Tzedek. As well as Derech Mitzvosecho, Biurei Hazohar, Ohr Hatorah, Sefer Chakirah, Sefer Halikutim & Sefer Hamaamorim. Among his famous quotes is “Tracht gut vet Zein gut — Think good and it will be good.” Three states: The first three of the seven Middos, - emotive attributes which are in fact the main Middos of the supernal Sefiros. In other words: This teaching of the Tzemach Tzedek implies that the connection between the three blessings in ‘Birkas Hamozon’ and these three emotive attributes is that the three blessings request and effect the elicitation of an

extended from each of the three separate and divided strands of ‘Chessed’, ‘Gevurah’ and ‘Tiferes’. Even from the strand of ‘Gevurah’. This is so because in reality, the reason that even from there additional blessings are drawn down to us, is because in holiness, even from the left side abundance is extended. This is particularly so, according to that which is explained in the ‘Rosh Hashono Maamorim’ and elsewhere in ‘Chassidus’ that the concept of ‘Gevurah’ additional blessing from Hashem’s three attributes of Chessed, Gevurah and Tiferes. Three strands: The general way that the supernal Sefiros are set up visually is in three vertical rows where Chochmah is on the right and Binah is on the Left and Daas is just below in the middle and then on the next tier Chessed is on the right, Gevurah on the Left and Tiferes just below in the middle. below them is Netzach on the right, Hod on the Left and Yesod is just below in the middle with Malchus below them all. The three Middos of ‘Chessed’, ‘Gevurah’ and ‘Tiferes’ are central to this array and therefore the request is for these

three strands. 17 Strand of Gevurah: Normally Gevurah is considered a limiter and associated with contraction, stringencies and judgement. 17 From there: From the supernal Middah of Gevurah. 17 From the left side: Gevurah is positioned of the 'left' in the Kabbalistic doctrines. 17 This is particularly so: This phenomenon of Blessing and spiritual energy emanating from the left-Gevurah strand is highlighted and emphasised a lot.

is a reinforcement of vitality. Most certainly that even from the strand of 'Gevurah' additional blessing will also be an extended. So, the objective of the first three blessings of 'Birkas Hamazon' is in order to draw down 17 additional blessings from the three supernal strands of 'Chessed', 'Gevurah' and 'Tiferes'. The fourth blessing it can be said corresponds to the supernal Sefirah of 'Malchus' (Kingship). In other words, the objective of the fourth Brocho is in order to draw down additional blessings Vitality: Even though in the traditional sense, the supernal Middah of Gevurah is pictured to indeed be the source for restrictions and limitations of Gdliness, nevertheless, Gevurah also possesses the capability to give off energy and effluence. Not only does Gevurah have the capability to do so, but the spiritual influence that Gevurah does emit is in fact in a way of "Might" and "Power", which both originate from the same Hebrew etymological root as Gevurah Thus, Gevurah also gives off physical energy; this is why our Sages of blessed memory call rain in the Talmud and in our prayers: :

גבורות: גשמים

-“The rain of might {Gevurah}”

or why in the Shemoneh Esrei prayer we say 'Atah Gibor... Morid HaGeshem'. 17 Draw down: From above and to reveal an additional blessing.

even from the Sefirah of 'Malchus'. 17 With this we can understand 17 what is the significance of why we are only Biblically obligated to make the first three blessings 17 and why the fourth blessing was only added by the Sages. This is because 17 the three strands of 'Chessed', 'Gevurah' and 'Tiferes' 17 already include 17 Malchus: Kingship. There are ten Sefiros in each of the four spiritual worlds. The names of the ten Sefirot are: Chochmah (wisdom), Binah (understanding), Daas (knowledge), Chessed (kindness), Gevurah (strength), Tiferes (beauty), Netzach (victory), Hod (splendour), Yesod (foundation), and Malchus (kingship). The supernal Sefirah of Malchus is not part of the three strands but is positioned below the other Sefiros so that it can receive from all those that are above it. It then becomes the Kesser (Crown) to the world below it as it becomes the giver of the light which it had received from the other Sefiros above it. Just as a King (who on the one hand is at the very top of the people whilst on the other hand without subjects is just another person), is dependent on his subjects this is because they make him who he is. 17 With this we can understand: the deeper reason in the inner dimension. 17 The first three blessings: (על־הַיָּדֵיךָ אֱלֹהֵינוּ וְעַל־הַיָּדֵיכֶם וְעַל־הַיָּדֵינוּ) (and)

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הBecause: In essence the three strands. **מ**Chessed, Gevurah and Tiferes: Even though at first glance, as explained above, Chessed, Gevurah and Tiferes are part of three separate and specific strands. These three strands each comprise the first nine Sefiros, Malchus being the last of the ten so it isn't included in the three strands. The reason for that is because the build and anatomy of Malchus is not designed to give off spiritual power to the Sefiros that precede it. Therefore, it isn't on the same plane as the other Sefiros.

the state of 'Malchus' **מ**and only thereafter **מ**is 'Malchus' listed again individually. **ט**Regarding the supernal chariot; it is known that the supernal chariot has primarily three legs which correspond to the patriarchs **א**Avrohom, Yitzchok and However, Chessed, Gevurah and Tiferes have an innate, essential connection with Malchus. **מ**Malchus: That is then why any physical, actual effect Chessed, Gevurah and Tiferes have is accompanied by the energy of Malchus as it is essentially intertwined and included in the former Sefiros. **מ**Thereafter: Only after Malchus is put into effect as it is lodged within the first three emotive attributes, only after it is utilised and simultaneously comprised in Chessed, Gevurah and Tiferes. **ט**Individually: With all this Kabbalistic interpretation, we can fully understand why there are three Biblical blessings in 'Bentching' and then thereafter an additional Rabbinic blessing. Because the first three Biblical blessings correspond to 'Chessed', 'Gevurah' and 'Tiferes' which all naturally possess an element of 'Malchus' in their core but then the additional Rabbinic blessing corresponding to Malchus is as it is on its own, removed from the three basic strands. Why? Because although the message of the fourth Blessing "Hatov Vehamaitiv", is already mentioned and discussed in the first three blessings, (Which is why from the Torah a fourth blessing is not required); just like in the Sefiros! Nevertheless, the Sefira of Malchus has an additional effluence when on its own, individually. Compared to the fourth, additional blessing. So It's always there, mentioned and repeated in the first three blessings naturally, and only after the first three blessings can it be listed again, but it's not biblically mandated. Supernal chariot: As described by the Prophet Yechezkel (1:1-28) **א**Patriarchs: In Chassidus it is explained the difference between the horse pulling the chariot and the chariot is that although the horse is subservient to the driver it is only because he is wearing

Yaakov and only later on is a fourth leg added which corresponds to Dovid Hamelech who represents the state of 'Kingship'. **ב**Similarly, regarding the elements **ב** blinkers and the driver is forcing the horse to be subservient. A chariot on the other hand does not have a will of its own at all. The reason why the Sages designated specifically the Patriarchs as Hashem's chariot, although every Jew's body becomes a 'chariot' when he performs a Mitzvah, is because the Patriarchs 'submission to the Divine Will was unique in its power, its scope, and its consistency. All their limbs were totally surrendered to the Divine Will throughout their lives — whereas with other Jews, only those limbs which perform a Mitzvah are a 'chariot',

and then only during the act. In fact, the same limb which today served as a “chariot” to Hashem’s Will might conceivably serve the opposite purpose tomorrow. 11 State of kingship: Just as in the previous cases, there is already completion with the number three, but missing Malchus as an individual entity. And only after Malchus is revealed through the first three can it be added alone as an independent entity. It isn’t a coincidence that Malchus means Kingship and sovereignty and the fourth leg of the Chariot, was designated for Dovid Hamelech. 12 The elements: From which the substance of the world is made. According to Kabbalah, the Universe is consisted of a combination of four basic elements: fire, air, water and earth. Every material and spiritual being consists of a unique combination of these four elements. Each of the four basic elements of the material world has fundamental characteristics, which are expressed, for instance, in its gravitational pull, temperature, state of mass, molecular density, dissemination and motion in space and so forth. Thus, these basic elements are clearly much more fundamental than the elements on Mendeleev’s Periodic Table, which is used in chemistry. The behaviour of the basic elements in the physical dimension also teaches us about their characteristics in the spiritual dimension, as well as their appearance and activity in the human mental forces. (adapted from Chabad.org)

the Sefer Yetzirah 13 only enumerates three elements 14 ‘fire’, ‘water’ and ‘air’, even though in the Medrash, 15 in the Zohar 16 and in the Rambam 17 they enumerate four 18 19 Sefer Yetzirah: Book of Formation, is the earliest extant book on Jewish esotericism. The book is traditionally ascribed to Avrohom Ovinu, although others attribute its writing to Rabbi Akiva. According to Rabbi Saadia Gaon, the objective of the book’s author was to convey in writing how the things of our universe came into existence. 20 Three elements: Sefer Yetzirah only lists three basic elements – fire, air and water – as the essential elements. The element of earth is not mentioned. 21 In the Midrash: (Bamidbar Rabbah, chapter 14) the four elements are mentioned in the description of the order of their place in creation, above one another. This appears in the chapter on the gifts presented by the heads of the twelve tribes of the B’nei Yisroel at the dedication of the Mishkon in the desert. 22 The Zohar: (Part 2, page 23, 2; page 254, 2; Part 3, page 225, 1 and elsewhere). In the Book of the Zohar, the four basic elements are mentioned in the context of the creation of Adam - the first human, referring to the parallels between these elements and the four corners of the earth, the four ministering angels (Raphael, Uriel, Michael and Gabriel) and more. 23 Rambam: Maimonides provides an extensive discussion of the four basic elements and their interrelationships on the physical plane, interfacing with the spiritual plane, in the Book of Science Hilchos Yesodei HaTorah (end of chapter 3 / beginning of chapter 4). 24 Four elements: In Tanya (chapter 1), the four basic elements are mentioned as the origin of the unfavourable characteristics of the natural animal soul of the human: fire is the source of anger and pride; water is the source of persecution after physical pleasures; air is the source of foolishness, idol talk, and boasting and earth is the source of depression, laziness and heaviness. In contrast, the Tanya also describes the presence of the four basic elements in the higher, divine soul and in the intellectual soul (chapter 3, Igeres HaKodesh chapter 15 and elsewhere).

elements: 'fire', 'water' 'air' and 'earth', because primarily there are three elements 'fire', 'water' and 'air' which themselves also include the element of 'earth'. And the element of 'earth' is only revealed at a later stage [with]in them.אס There is a well-known example בס that illustrates this; when one places a pot of 'water' to boil on the 'fire' and there is [room for] some 'air' in between אס it then builds Because: So why is it that the earth is not listed with the other three in the early Kabbalistic work the Sefer Yetzirah? אס In them: And then thereafter as an individual entity without any connection the previous three elements. בס Example: In his book, Pardes Rimonim (Portal 11, chapter 3), the 16th Century Tzfas Kabbalist the 'Ramak' (Rabbi Moshe Cordovero) presents an example that may explain why the element of earth is mentioned and "revealed" only later: water in a pot near fire, with the air in between. After the water is heated, bits of earth develop, which emerge as the element of earth. This parable is brought by the Tzemach Tzedek in Ohr Hatorah on Parshas Yisro from the Ramak (9:3:3 on Sefaria.org) if one was to allow the water in the pan to boil away and then to put more water into the pot and then let that boil away and continue doing that for a while there would be a build-up in the pot of a collection of earth particles. Like a dusty residue in the pot and that is from the particles which represent the earth particles. We see it as limescale or hardness in the water. אס In between: So that together there is a blend and fusion between the three foundational elements: fire, air and water.

up [a dust like earth particle which represents the] earth element which is submerged within. טס Similarly, it could be understood how the three strands of 'Chessed', 'Gevurah' and 'Tiferes' above also include everything within them הס and it is from them that Malchus is also eventually revealed. Therefore, from the Torah יס there are only three Brochos זס but afterwards the Sages of blessed memory added the fourth blessing. טס בס Submerged within: Yet again, the same phenomenon repeats itself, this idea is universal. Once all three of the foundational elements have played a role, it's time for the fourth and last element to come into play in a revealed manner, expressing itself as an individual. הס Everything within them: Everything, even the Brochos and spirituality from Malchus. יס From the Torah: In Bentching. זס Three Brochos: Which bring abundance and added blessings from the supernal 'Middos' of 'Chessed', 'Gevurah' and 'Tiferes' and they all include Malchus within them. נס Fourth blessing: Of Sefiras Hamalchus alone and unadulterated.

The purpose of 'Birkas Hamazon' is to draw down blessing טס into the one who is Bentching's portion of this world. This is because even the Mitzvos אט become encloded within material objects בט such as woollen Tzitzis and leather and parchment for Tefilin. So, most certainly one of the objectives of 'Birkas Hamazon' over physical food items גט is to draw down blessing into [the] physical objects דט such as 'land' and 'food' סט. הט Draw down blessing: As they are receiving influence from the supernal Middos. Portion of the world: And to bring it into revelation. אט Even the Mitzvos: Which are an expression of Hashem's Holy Will, descend from above to below. בט Material objects: We see that the general purpose and intention for the world's creation is that this physical, lowly world should be transformed into a place of dwelling for G-dliness. גט Physical food items: Because the whole purpose of the food is in order to make a Brocho on it and to physically eat it. So most certainly the purpose of the Brocho is to draw down blessings... דט Physical objects: And thank Hashem for them.

הע Land and food: We are able to achieve and fulfil the purpose of creation by thanking Hashem and

This is also ו why we conclude each of the first three blessings in the ‘Birkas Hamozon’ with a Boruch. This is because the conclusion is like a seal that it should not be interfered with by an outsider. ת Because since the ‘Hamshocha’ through ‘Birkas Hamozon’ is drawn right down below as mentioned, הע there needs to be extra care that it should not be interfered with by an outsider. ט spiritually uplifting the physical world with our Birkas Hamozon on physical food and the physical land. This also brings about additional abundance and additional blessings from Hashem for our physical wellbeing in to the actual Gashmius. ו This is also: The deeper reason: ת An outsider: It is explained in Chassidus that the reason why blessings end with a “Boruch” is analogous to when one writes a letter, he seals it to ensure no outsider will read the letter upon its journey to the receiver of the letter. So too is it with our blessings - we want that they should have an effect, but we are also weary that Hashem’s sustenance to us shouldn’t fall into the wrong places, namely, the “Sitra Achra” {literally ‘the other side’ referring to evil forces} The reason why this seal is so vital in regard to Birkas Hamozon is... הע As mentioned: Because that is the intention of the Brocho that Birkas Hamozon brings G-dliness the way down below to this physical world through the blessing of the physical food, as we explained before. ט An outsider: Because on the more supernal spiritual levels the Sitra Achra has no access and therefore there is no chance that it can nurture from holiness.

This is also consistent with what is explained in Chassidus that the idea of sealing with a Boruch is a Hamshocha of a ‘reflected light’. This is also specifically to do with ‘down below’ because the seal, the returning light, returns from below back to above. From all that was discussed above it is apparent that the purpose of ‘Birkas Hamozon’ is that the blessings shall specifically be drawn right down below. חפ Reflected light: It is explained in Kabbala and Chassidus that Divine light interacts with the world in two distinct ways: ‘Or Yoshor’ - ‘Direct Light’ which shines from above to below and contracts level by level, in a gradual way. ‘Or Chozar’ ‘Reflected Light’ rebounds back from below to above passing through all the created beings and worlds and ascends higher. Which is thanks to the Avodas Hashem achieved below which elevates the worlds and created beings so that they do not hinder and conceal the Divine light too much. Furthermore, the ‘Direct Light’ has an advantage in that it originates from a higher source whereas the advantage of the “Reflected Light” is that as it passes through the worlds, it becomes stronger and comes out more powerful. חפ Down below: And not just remain abstract in spirituality.

With this we will understand why we are particular to recite ‘Birkas Hamozon’ even when only consuming the volume of an olive. This is because even when being particular about one’s own conduct and going beyond the letter of the law one supersedes any limit or boundary. פ Nevertheless, גפ since the intention is that the blessing shall be drawn right down below, דפ therefore, there also needs to be a specific measure, הפ which will be the difference between the performance of Mitzvos ופ and refining one’s portion of the world, זפ חפ Boundary: That his Avodah and effort are way beyond that which is expected of him to the

extent that it is without boundaries. **ג** Nevertheless: We don't say that a person must Bentch if he eats 'anything' as mentioned earlier on in the Maamor, rather we ascribe the measurement of an olive as the minimum consumption to obligate one to Bentch. **ד** Right down below: So that it has a very physical expression in a revealed manner. **ה** Specific measure: A minimum of a Kezayis. In order to bring the Brocha down below in the physical, worldly realm. That being the physical measurement of the olive. **ו** Performance of Mitzvos: Which personify the idea of physical investment. **ז** One's portion of the world: Man's service of engaging in the

which can be achieved through eating and such like. **ח** Regarding Mitzvos even though they are encloded within material objects **ט** they are nevertheless still beyond measure and limitation. Whereas eating food **י** specifically needs to be associated with a minimum measurement. **יא** Due to this inference in which the B'nei Yisroel are world and taking something physical and refining it, using it for holiness and good. Thus, separating the good out of the bad and elevating it to holiness. **יב** Eating and such like: Through engaging and coming into contact with worldly matter in various ways. Every person has his allotted part of this world that he personally needs to refine. **יג** Material objects: Like our example earlier on with Tefillin and Tzitzis which are actual, physical items. Beyond measure and limitation: There is an unlimited amount of room to improve and beautify the Mitzvos. **יד** Whereas eating food: The Avodah of refining the physical world, which is effectuated through coming into contact with world matter. **יט** Minimum measurement: Whereas for the consumption of anything less than this minimum amount one cannot 'Bentch' and one cannot draw down the abundance and additional blessings as discussed.

particular with themselves ... **כ** we prompt Hashem to shine His holy countenance upon Yisroel as the Possuk states:“

יִשְׂרָאֵל ה' פָּנָיו אֵלָיךְ צֵד

May Hashem raise His countenance toward you”

and merit even ,

וַיִּשְׂמַח לְךָ שָׁלוֹם

י ז “May Hashem grant you peace”.

As our Sages of blessed memory state **י** that when the blessing of peace is here so are all the other blessings because all the blessings are included in peace even the blessing of the coming of Moshiach Our Righteous one and it shall be as the Possuk states“ **י** The B'nei Yisroel

Particular with themselves: As discussed earlier we are particular and stringent to Bentsh even after only consuming a 'KeZayis' volume of bread. As the Possuk states: In the priestly blessings. Merit even: The fruition of all the other blessings that are associated with the priestly blessings. Sages of blessed memory state: on the Possuk in Parshas Bechukosai “ ;

וְנָתַתִּי שְׁלוֹם בְּאַרְצִי

And I will grant peace in the Land”

and Rashi states on the words: “And I will grant peace: You might say, “Here is food, and here is drink, but if there is no peace, there is nothing!” Scripture, therefore, states, after all this blessing, “I will grant peace in the Land.” From here, we learn that peace is equal to everything else. And so, this is illustrated in our morning prayers, when we say: “Blessed are You, Hashem... Who... makes peace and creates everything” a paraphrase of the verse (Yeshaya 45:7) - see Ber. 11b; Toras Kohanim 26:7. As the Possuk states: Shmos (14:8) _

וַיַּחֲזֹק ה' אֶת־לִבְפַּרְעֹה מֶלֶךְ־מִצְרַיִם וַיִּרְדֹּף אֶחָדָם בְּנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל וּבְנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל אֵלֶיָּהֶם בָּיִדָּה־רַמָּה

And Hashem hardened the heart of Pharaoh, the King of Mitzrayim, and he chased after the B'nei Yisroel, and the B'nei

were marching out triumphantly” coming“to a good and spacious land”, the holy land, May it be very soon and in actuality! Yisroel were marching out triumphantly.” Triumphantly: And as Rashi says מִיָּדָּה־רַמָּה, with a high hand. With lofty and openly displayed 'Gevurah' might. Coming to: As the Possuk states: (Shmos 3:8) _

וַאֲרָדָה צִיְלוֹמַיִם מִצְרַיִם וְלִהְיוֹתִי עֲלֵתוֹ מִן־הָאָרֶץ הַהִוא אֶל־אֶרֶץ טוֹבָה וְרַחֲבָה אֶל־אֶרֶץ בְּתָחִיל לִבְשׂוֹד בְּשׂוֹד

-



I have descended to rescue them from the hand[s] of the Mitzriim and to bring them up from that land, to a good and spacious land, to a land flowing with milk and honey, to the place of the Canaanim, the Chittim, the Amorim, the Perizzim, the Chivvim, and the Yevusim.”

לעילוי נשמת מרת רָעָה כִּיל צִפּוֹרָה בת ר' שאול אלישע ע"ה לע"נ הנע' חיה מוסיא
ע"ה בת יבלח"ט הרה"ח ר' מ

נ

שיחי לע"נ מרת אילנה בת אברהם ע"ה לע"נ ר' שמעון רפאל בן ר' אברהם הלוי
ע"ה לע"נ ר' בנימין אליעזר שמואל ע"ה בן יבלח"ט הרה"ח ר' יוסף שאול עזרא שיחי
תנצב"ה בלע המות לנצח ומחה ה' אלוקים דמעה מעל כל פנים הקיצו ורננו שוכני
עפר לזכות יום הולדת שמח הרה"ח ר' מרדכי ליב בן פריידא שליט"א כ"ח מנחם-אב

Happy Birthday Dr.

Mordechai Slutzkin Shlita May you be blessed with

אריכת ימים וטובות געזונטהייט און פריילאכהייט לזכות יום הולדת שמח
הבחה"ת שמעון רפאל הלוי בן יעל טאניא שי" כ"ה מנחם-אב

Happy Birthday Shimmy Levy Sheychye

שנת הצלחה במבצעים ועבודת השם

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ובהתקשרות לאדמו"ר נשיאנו

Sacred text – pPlaegea|se do not discard